



Your Laptop Display

3 ways to check how good it really is

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Last weekend, I was halfway through a Netflix show when I noticed something odd. The scene was meant to be dark and dramatic, but on my laptop it looked surprisingly flat. Shadows turned grey, colours felt muted, and the whole frame lacked that punchy contrast you expect from a tense moment. I paused the episode, cleaned the screen, adjusted the brightness, and even tilted the display, but nothing changed.

Later, I played the same scene on my sister's laptop and everything looked instantly better. The colours were richer, blacks looked deeper, and the frame just felt more alive. Nothing had changed on my laptop. I had just never noticed how limited the display was until I saw how the scene was supposed to look on a better panel.

The good news is that you do not need to be a colour expert to understand your laptop's screen quality. There are a few simple but surprisingly effective tests anyone can try at home.

Here are three cool tricks to help you figure out exactly how good your laptop display really is. Whether you spend your time streaming, working, gaming, or casually browsing, these tricks will help you understand what your laptop screen can and cannot do.

Trick 1: Judge colour accuracy and brightness

Every laptop brand talks about colour accuracy. One claims 100% sRGB coverage. Another promises a super bright panel or advertises impressive contrast ratios. But unless you know how to check these things yourself, it all becomes marketing jargon. This first trick helps you see the truth.

There are free colour test patterns available online. These include gradients, blocks, greyscale bars, sharp text samples, and saturated colours. When you display these patterns full screen, you can instantly tell how well your laptop is handling colours.

A simple colour bar pattern shows you whether reds look truly red or if they lean slightly orange. Whether your blues are deep or washed out. Whether your yellows look natural or too pale. You do not need technical knowledge. Your eyes will naturally notice when something does not look right.

Brightness levels also become easier to judge. If you look at a greyscale pattern that moves from pure black to pure white, you should ideally be able to distinguish each shade. If the darkest greys look the same as pure black, your contrast is not great. If the lightest greys all look like white, your display struggles with highlights.

This trick also reveals issues like colour banding. In a perfect gradient, colours should flow smoothly from one shade to another. If you see steps or harsh transitions, your display is not producing the full range of tones. This matters a lot for creative work and even for watching HDR content.

